# OFFICIAL SAFETY CAR PROTOCOLS

**Season 2026**

Version 1.0
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# 1. PURPOSE

The Safety Car Protocols define the operational procedures governing the deployment, conduct, and restart of Safety Car (SC) and Virtual Safety Car (VSC) periods during Championship sessions.

The objective is to:

- Ensure driver safety
- Maintain sporting fairness
- Prevent strategic exploitation
- Standardise restart procedures

These protocols are binding on all drivers and teams.

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# 2. SAFETY CAR DEPLOYMENT

## 2.1 Grounds for Deployment

The Race Director may deploy the Safety Car under circumstances including but not limited to:

- Multi-car collision
- Severe on-track obstruction
- Retired vehicle in dangerous position
- Heavy damage debris
- Server instability affecting multiple drivers

The decision of the Race Director is final.

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## 2.2 Notification

Upon deployment:

- Drivers will receive in-game SC notification
- Overtaking is immediately prohibited
- Drivers must reduce speed safely

Failure to comply may result in penalties.

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# 3. CONDUCT UNDER SAFETY CAR

## 3.1 Delta Compliance

Drivers must:

- Respect prescribed delta time
- Avoid excessive acceleration or braking
- Maintain predictable pace

Brake testing is strictly prohibited.

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## 3.2 Overtaking Restrictions

Overtaking is strictly prohibited except when:

- A car is damaged and significantly slowed
- A driver is instructed to unlap
- The leading car is retiring

Unauthorized overtaking will result in penalty.

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## 3.3 Gap Management

Drivers must:

- Maintain reasonable distance to car ahead

- Avoid dangerous acceleration/deceleration patterns
- Avoid warming tactics that endanger competitors

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# 4. PIT STOPS DURING SAFETY CAR

Drivers may pit under SC conditions.

However:

- Unsafe release will result in penalty
- Speed limit violations remain enforced
- Pit entry and exit blend lines must be respected

Strategic pit advantage is permitted unless otherwise restricted by race control.

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# 5. LAPPED CARS PROCEDURE

If Race Control allows lapped cars to overtake:

- Only specified drivers may pass
- They must do so safely
- They must rejoin at back of queue
- No racing permitted until restart

If not permitted, all cars must remain in current order.

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# 6. SAFETY CAR RESTART PROCEDURE

## 6.1 Safety Car In This Lap

When the Safety Car lights are extinguished:

- The race leader assumes control of the pace
- Drivers must maintain formation
- Sudden braking or acceleration is prohibited

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## 6.2 Restart Zone

The leader may accelerate at any time after:

- Final corner exit
- Or designated restart zone

Overtaking is permitted only after crossing the control line.

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## 6.3 Restart Violations

Penalties may apply for:

- Jumping the restart
- Overtaking before line
- Causing collision during restart

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# 7. VIRTUAL SAFETY CAR (VSC)

## 7.1 Deployment

VSC may be deployed for:

- Minor debris
- Single car recovery
- Temporary instability

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## 7.2 Delta Enforcement

Drivers must:

- Stay above minimum delta
- Avoid gaining time advantage
- Maintain consistent speed

Significant delta violation may result in time penalty.

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## 7.3 VSC Ending

When VSC ends:

- Drivers may resume racing immediately
- No sudden aggressive weaving permitted
- Track limits remain enforced

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# 8. DISCONNECTION DURING SAFETY CAR

If a driver disconnects:

- Race Director may extend SC
- May trigger session restart (if within first 3 laps)
- Or classify position at time of disconnect

Decision remains at Race Control discretion.

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# 9. ABUSE OF SAFETY CAR

The following actions are strictly prohibited:

- Intentional crashing to trigger SC
- Coordinated team manipulation
- Brake testing
- Artificially slowing field

Such conduct may result in:

- Disqualification
- Championship points deduction
- Suspension
- Permanent ban

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# 10. FORCE MAJEURE

In extraordinary circumstances (server failure, mass disconnection):

Race Control may:

- Red flag session
- Restart race
- Revert to previous lap classification
- Apply average delta correction

All decisions are final.

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# 11. FINAL AUTHORITY

The Race Director retains ultimate authority over:

- Deployment
- Duration
- Restart timing
- Classification during SC/VSC

All participants accept these decisions as binding.

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